

CULTIVATING HOUSEPLANTS

Growing indoor plants and helping them flourish is a mixture of instinct, knowledge, and luck; I can help with the middle one, with these essential care tips on cultivating. Once you gain experience, you will be well on the way to creating your own indoor oasis.

Watering

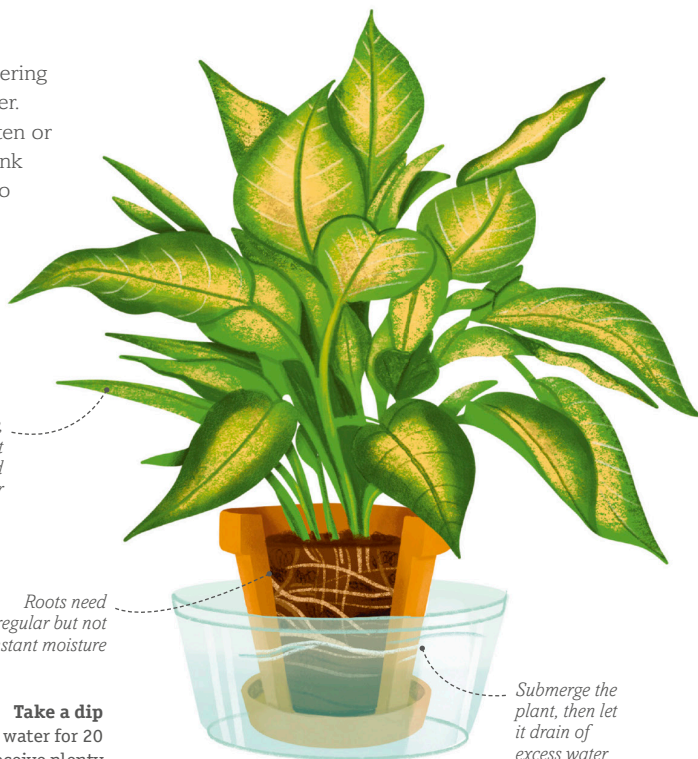
Most plants are killed by kindness—from overwatering by being left to sit in water. Either water little and often or take your plants to the sink or bath and leave them to sit in the water for 20 minutes, then allow them to drain and return them to their positions.

Leaves of a healthy, hydrated plant should be turgid and have good color

Roots need regular but not constant moisture

Take a dip

Standing houseplants in water for 20 minutes will ensure they receive plenty of moisture without sitting in water for too long, which can lead to root rot.



Submerge the plant, then let it drain of excess water